

A-State tips UTEP, 2-1; Gura's 14th

By DAVE HICKS
Republic Sports Writer

EL PASO — Early returns had Arizona State a 2-1 winner yesterday in its baseball series opener against Texas-El Paso.

But Andy Cohen quickly audited and made it 9-3.

"Let's face it," said the Miners' coach after watching Larry Gura set down his club with a five-hitter, "we're not in the same class with Arizona State.

"Bobby Winkles (Sun Devil coach) puts nine men out there. I have about three and the rest are boys, and we scored only because of my base-coaching boo-bee."

The one-run triumph, not quite as close as it looks, gave ASU an 11-2 league record. The Devils can earn a certain divisional title tie with a double-header (first game, noon) sweep today.

Gura, once again a control master who walked no one and struck out six, recorded his 14th victory in 15 decisions and would have had a shutout but for a weird play.

In the seventh inning the smooth left-hander was coasting effortlessly, having allowed only three base runners, when Ron Hix doubled.

With two out John Miller grounded to second baseman Lenny Randle who accidentally sat down on the job. By the time he got up Miller was safe at first.

Meanwhile, Hix had rounded third, thought Miller was grounding into an inning-ending out, and headed for the dugout.

Awakened to the fact he was the only one leaving the field, Hix jumped back onto the base path, was trapped in a rundown, and scored when he jarred the ball loose from catcher Billy Cotton at the plate.

A-State's 10-hit attack produced only two runs against loser Marc Bombard (7-5), who kept the winner away from a big inning.

ASU	ab	r	h	bi	UTEP	ab	r	h	bi
Randle 2b	3	1	1	0	Sandoval 2b	4	0	2	0
Dick rf	5	0	2	0	Morales cf	4	0	0	0
Alasrand lf	4	0	3	1	Blanco 3b	4	0	0	0
Powell cf	4	1	0	0	Hix c	4	1	2	0
Cotton c	4	0	1	0	Butler lf	4	0	0	0
Osborn 1b	4	0	2	1	Miller 1b	2	0	1	0
Brenner 3b	3	0	1	0	Carroasco ss	3	0	0	0
Deller ss	3	0	0	0	McLellan rf	3	0	0	0
Gura p	2	0	0	0	Bombard p	3	0	0	0
Totals	32	2	10	2	Totals	31	1	5	0
ARIZONA STATE	1 0 0				1 0 0	0 0 0			
UTEP	0 0 0				0 0 0	1 0 0			
E—Cotton, Randle. DP—ASU 1, UTEP 1. LOB—ASU 9, UTEP 4. 2B—Randle, Dick, Sandoval, Hix. SB—Powell, Osborn. Sac—Gura.									
Gura (W, 14-1)									
Bombard (L, 7-5)									
IP H R ER BB SO									
9 10 2 2 5 4									